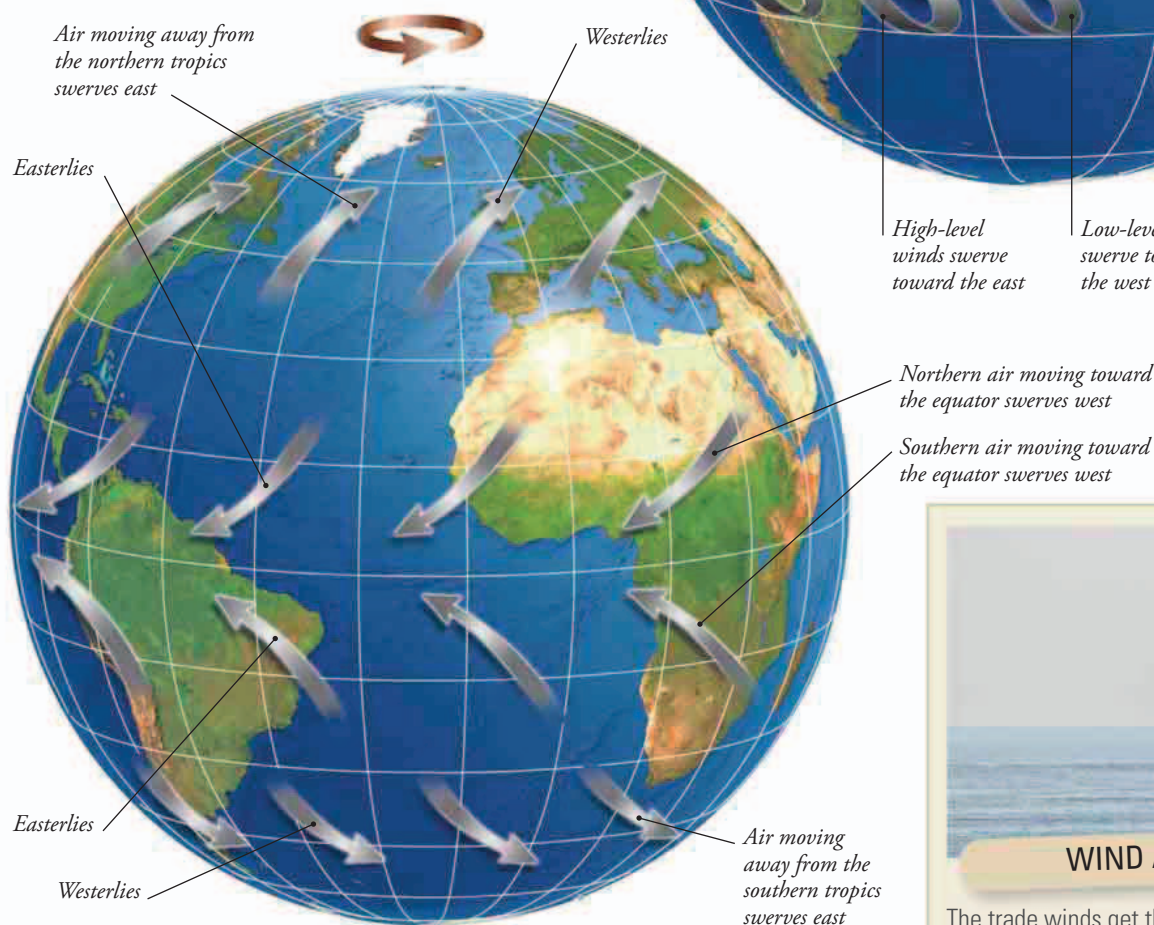
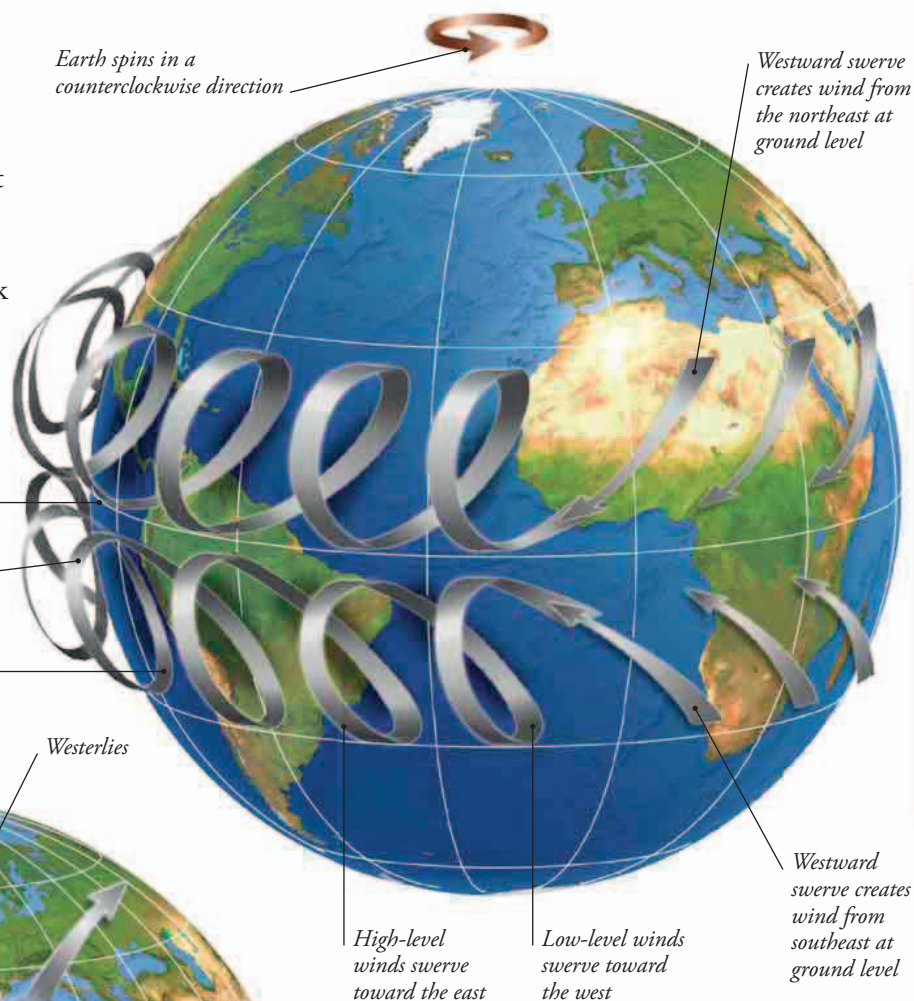




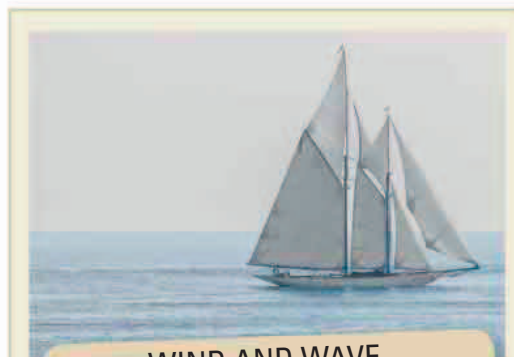
SPIN AND SWERVE

Air moving north or south is pushed off course by Earth's spin. North of the equator it swerves right, while south of the equator it swerves left. This means that the high-level air flowing away from the tropics in each Hadley cell veers east, but when it flows back toward the equator at low level it is pushed west. As a result, the airflow in each circulation cell spirals around the globe.



PREVAILING WINDS

In different parts of the world, winds usually blow from a particular direction. These are called prevailing winds. In each Hadley cell, for example, air moving toward the equator at low altitude swerves west, and this drives the prevailing winds in the tropics, known as the trade winds, or easterlies (because they blow from the east). Prevailing winds blow most reliably over oceans. Land tends to disrupt prevailing winds, creating seasonal, local winds.



WIND AND WAVE

The trade winds get their name from the sailing ships that used them to carry goods across the oceans. Atlantic traders would sail west to America on the trade winds, then return east using the westerlies farther north. Ships sailed around the world using the powerful westerly winds in the Southern Ocean, and racing sailors still follow the same route.